

Proof before explanation · Sequence before content · Elevation before error

THE CREDIBILITY STACK

- 1

Legal Validation
IRS makes self-dealing impossible. Not a policy. Federal law. Lead with this every time.
- 2

Market Validation
\$1.9 billion in institutional bond orders in 2024. BlackRock, Vanguard, Fidelity.
- 3

Peer Validation
Real affiliates, real outcomes, specific to the audience. Stories from people who have lived it.
- 4

Familiar Analogies
Berkshire Hathaway for financial audiences. AWS for operational audiences.
- 5

Capabilities
What Inperium actually does. Last, because this is where most people start. It is exactly wrong.

THE THREE ALTITUDES

30-SECOND · Conferences, introductions, hallways

Inperium is a nonprofit platform that helps human services organizations grow stronger without giving up who they are. It does not operate programs. It provides the financial infrastructure, back-office support, and capital access that most nonprofits cannot build on their own, while every organization keeps its name, its board, its leadership, and its mission. Think of it as the strength of a national system with the soul of a local organization.

3-MIN: Context → Problem → Model → Proof → Invitation

10-MIN: Legal → Financial → Track record → Analogy → Capabilities

Then stop talking. Watch the listener. If they lean in, move to the 3-minute version.

WORDS THAT WORK

✗ STOP SAYING

✓ START SAYING

Control

Governance standards

Takeover

Affiliation

Consolidator / Parent co.

Supporting org / Constellation

Target

Prospective affiliate

Portfolio

Community of organizations

Acquisition / Buyout

Partnership / Capital investment

Restructuring

Mission amplification

We provide/ We give you

"You gain access to"

Human Voice: Every substantive answer needs at least one sentence where a person appears. Not a statistic. A person.

Stat-Then-Meaning: Every number needs a translation into human terms. The number earns attention. The translation earns memory.

THE BENEFIT BRIDGE

1

Impact First

What it means for the people served

2

Advantage Second

What it means for the CEO and board

3

Mechanics Third

How the governance works

"Families continue to receive the same services, your leadership stays in place, and the legal structure enforces both."

"The sequence is the strategy."

BEFORE YOU WALK IN: Curious → 30-second version · Skeptical → Credibility Stack · Afraid → Benefit Bridge

COMMUNICATION ROLES		
ROLE	TIERS	SCOPE
GREEN	1, 2, 3	Full model mastery. Any question at any depth.
YELLOW	1, ltd 2	Personal experience only. Own affiliation journey.
RED	1 only	30-sec version. Opens doors. Knows when to elevate.
BACKSTAGE	Internal	Internal coordination. No prospect-facing comms.

ELEVATION LANGUAGE
<i>"This deserves a more thorough conversation than I can give it right now. Let me bring in someone who can walk you through this in the detail it deserves."</i>
<i>"That goes beyond what I experienced directly. Let me connect you with someone who can walk you through the structural side"</i>
<i>"I want to give you an accurate answer. Let me get back to you by end of day tomorrow."</i>
Never say "I am not authorized." Never say "above my pay grade" Elevation is attentiveness, not inadequacy.

CONVERSATION TIERS + ELEVATION TRIGGERS		
1	Introductions, events, conferences	Pricing/terms asked · Project named · Board/attorney mentioned · Shifts from what to how
2	Substantive · Decisions on table	Contract terms wanted · Board approval needed · Strategic concern raised · You don't know
3	Senior authority · Negotiations	C-suite counterparts expect C-suite · No solo operation without prep & debrief

THREE OBJECTIONS YOU WILL HEAR
"We will lose our independence." <i>"You should be concerned. That concern is exactly why the legal structure exists."</i>
"This sounds too good to be true." <i>"Ask the affiliate CEOs who felt the same way."</i>
"This is private equity in disguise." <i>"The IRS prohibits private equity returns here. Structural difference — not marketing."</i>

EVIDENCE STANDARD
Counterpart Aspiration What do they care about, in their language?
Constraint Identified What is the real barrier to moving forward?
Decision Advanced What is true now that was not true before?
Agreed Next Step Who does what, by when?

PRE-FLIGHT CHECKLIST
☐ Can I state this counterpart's likely concern in one sentence?
☐ Do I know which tier this conversation is likely to reach?
☐ Do I have a story loaded that fits this audience?
☐ Do I know my elevation trigger and who I'm handing off to?

*"Know your role.
Follow the sequence.
Elevate with confidence."*